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Reflections on the Journey

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Hello, Curious Minds!

Welcome to the latest edition of the "Being Curious" newsletter! This week, I'm excited to share some of the resources that have inspired me lately. Each one has enriched my journey and added fresh perspectives that continue to shape my path. From thought-provoking books to meaningful TED Talks, I hope these recommendations offer you insight, inspiration, and maybe a few moments of reflection. Alongside these, I've also been reflecting on the value of passive adventure — exploring new ideas, absorbing wisdom, and seeing the world from different perspectives, all from the comfort of your own space.

Before we dive into the list, I'd like to share a bit about why these selections are meaningful to me. Embracing a growth mindset has helped me approach challenges with curiosity and optimism. I believe in nurturing a culture where learning and gratitude intersect, fueling both personal and professional growth. I'm grateful to share these with you, hoping they'll add a spark to your work-life.

Let's explore these together — and remember, you can start applying them *right now*!

Top 5 Audiobooks I Listened To

■

Reflective and engaging stories, each one offering new perspectives and lessons.

1. **Will** – Will Smith's honest journey of resilience and finding oneself.
2. **Niksen: The Lost Art of Doing Nothing** – A refreshing take on embracing rest and stillness.
3. **The Pilani Pioneers** – Celebrating the innovation and spirit of Pilani's entrepreneurial alumni.
4. **The Psychology of Money** – A look into the human side of financial habits and attitudes.
5. **Steal Like an Artist** – An inspiring guide on finding creativity through observation and openness.

Top 5 TED Talks That Made an Impact

Insightful talks that challenge perceptions and inspire meaningful change.

1. **"The Power of Vulnerability" by Brené Brown** – Redefining vulnerability as a source of strength and connection.
2. **"How Great Leaders Inspire Action" by Simon Sinek** – The transformative impact of beginning with 'why' in leadership.
3. **"Why People Believe They Can't Draw" by Graham Shaw** – Releasing creativity by challenging our self-limiting beliefs.
4. **"The First 20 Hours: How to Learn Anything" by Josh Kaufman** – Unpacking the potential of focused, deliberate practice.
5. **"The Danger of the Single Story" by Asha Curran** – A powerful reminder to approach life with empathy and kindness.

Top 5 Gratitude Practices

Simple habits to cultivate appreciation and joy in daily life.

1. **#TuesdayGiving** – Making each Tuesday a day to give something meaningful to others.
2. **Daily Thank You** – Beginning every day with gratitude to set a positive tone.
3. **Partner Appreciation** – Expressing thanks after every good meal together as a celebration of connection.
4. **Thanking My Kids** – Reminding myself of the joy and growth my children bring to my life.
5. **Spontaneous Gratitude Notes** – Sending thank-you notes whenever I feel grateful for someone's presence or support.

Top 5 Physical Books I Read

Enriching reads that offer fresh perspectives on personal and professional growth.

1. **Start with WHY** – A call to align with purpose and lead with

1. **Start with WHY** – A call to align with purpose and lead with authenticity.
2. **Shoe Dog** – Phil Knight's story of building Nike, filled with resilience and grit.
3. **Atomic Habits** – James Clear's actionable strategies for forming meaningful habits.
4. **The Subtle Art of Not Giving a F*ck** – Mark Manson on clarity and focusing on what truly matters.
5. **The Courage to Be Disliked** – A philosophical journey into self-acceptance and authenticity.

Thank you for taking a moment to explore these insights. I'd love to hear what resonated with you this week — feel free to share your thoughts or any resources you're exploring! Let's keep growing and learning together, as curious minds on this journey.

Until next time, stay curious and stay inspired!

Vikas Surani

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Seasoned IT professional with more than 30y experience in diverse r...

1y ...

Hi Vikas, you are doing a wonderful job. Keep going.

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**Sree Sahasranaman**  · 1st

SVP & Business Unit Head: Healthcare & Life-sciences@ Tata Elxsi |...

1y ...

The psychology of money is good one to read to fuel the VGO office my friend.. Being curious is keeping us on toes :-)

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Being Curious

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